

SoundBridge Product Requirements Document

Product definition for design frontend backend data and commercial development

Version 1.0

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Status Development baseline

Purpose. This document defines the product scope, user experience, commercial model, system requirements, and delivery criteria for SoundBridge. It is intended to align product, design, frontend, backend, data, AI, security, and business teams before production development.

Product decision. SoundBridge will launch as a professional network and operating workspace for music creators. The minimum viable product combines professional profiles, discovery, collaboration, opportunities, release planning, royalty education and estimation, and a clearly governed set of AI assistants. Free access supports adoption; Pro access monetizes deeper intelligence, automation, and higher usage limits.

Document control

Field	Value
Product	SoundBridge
Document owner	SoundBridge product team
Primary readers	Product, design, frontend, backend, data, AI, security, legal, and commercial teams
Current prototype	Separate HTML, CSS, and JavaScript pages using browser localStorage and demonstration data
Production direction	React application with authenticated APIs, persistent storage, observability, and secure third party integrations
Backend status	To be implemented by a separate backend team
Approval required from	Product owner, technical lead, design lead, legal or compliance reviewer, and commercial lead

Contents

- 1 Executive summary
- 2 Product vision and principles
- 3 Problem statement
- 4 Target users and jobs
- 5 Scope and release strategy
- 6 Information architecture
- 7 Core user journeys
- 8 Functional requirements
- 9 AI assistant system
- 10 Royalty intelligence
- 11 Membership and monetization
- 12 Production architecture
- 13 Data and integration requirements
- 14 Security privacy legal and trust
- 15 Analytics and success measures
- 16 Nonfunctional requirements
- 17 Delivery plan and acceptance
- 18 Risks dependencies and open decisions
- 19 Appendix

1 Executive summary

SoundBridge is a professional network and creator operating system for artists, producers, songwriters, audio engineers, managers, A and R professionals, legal professionals, visual creators, and other music industry participants. It addresses a fragmented creator journey: people discover collaborators on one service, plan releases in disconnected documents, interpret royalty statements manually, search for opportunities across informal channels, and obtain business guidance from sources with inconsistent quality.

The product unifies identity, network, workflow, education, and decision support. Users create a professional profile, select career goals, discover relevant people and opportunities, manage collaboration requests, prepare release plans, estimate and track music income, and access specialized AI assistants. The product must remain useful on the Free plan while making Pro valuable through expanded AI usage, advanced royalty analysis, deeper analytics, priority matching, and more comprehensive planning tools.

The current browser prototype validates navigation, visual direction, onboarding logic, personalization, discovery filters, a streaming royalty estimator, and statement-upload interactions. It is not the production application. Demo profiles, illustrative royalty rates, simulated platform connections, and localStorage persistence must be replaced with real services and governed data before launch.

2 Product vision and principles

2.1 Vision

Enable every music creator to understand their career, find the right people, plan stronger releases, protect their rights, and make more informed commercial decisions from one trusted workspace.

2.2 Product principles

Principle	Product implication
Creator first	Optimize for independent and developing creators without excluding professional teams.
Useful before payment	Free users must complete meaningful tasks; Pro expands capability rather than unlocking basic dignity.
Explain before automate	Show users why a recommendation or estimate exists and what information influenced it.
Global with local context	Support African markets and global careers, including relevant currencies, platforms, territories, and rights education.
Human accountability	AI assists decisions but does not replace lawyers, accountants, managers, or other licensed professionals.
Privacy by design	Music, contracts, royalty statements, identity data, and financial data require explicit consent and strong access controls.
Progressive complexity	Onboarding remains short; advanced configuration appears only when relevant to the user's goals.

3 Problem statement

3.1 User problems

- Creators struggle to find credible collaborators whose skills, genre, location, availability, and working style match their needs.
- Professional identity and credits are scattered across social profiles, streaming services, press links, and private documents.
- Release planning is inconsistent, causing missed deadlines, incomplete metadata, weak promotion, and unregistered rights.
- Royalty statements are difficult to interpret, and many creators do not understand master, mechanical, performance, neighboring rights, sync, producer, or publishing income.
- Independent creators often lack affordable access to career strategy, A and R feedback, release guidance, content planning, and understandable legal information.
- Relevant grants, showcases, jobs, briefs, and partnership opportunities are fragmented and difficult to verify.

3.2 Business opportunity

SoundBridge can acquire users through a useful free professional network and retain them through recurring workflow. Subscription revenue can be supplemented over time by verified opportunities, team plans, enterprise or institution partnerships, and carefully governed transaction or referral revenue. Monetization must never depend on selling confidential creator data.

4 Target users and jobs

Persona	Primary jobs	Key needs
Independent artist	Build profile, find collaborators, plan releases, grow audience, understand income	Simple guidance, visibility, trusted connections, affordability
Producer or songwriter	Show credits, find artists, manage projects, agree splits	Portfolio proof, matching, collaboration workflow, rights clarity
Engineer or visual creator	Find paid work and build reputation	Searchable services, availability, briefs, messaging, trust signals
Manager or team member	Coordinate careers, releases, opportunities, and reporting	Shared workspace, permissions, dashboards, task ownership
A and R or industry professional	Discover talent and monitor momentum	Search, filters, verified profiles, consented insights
Emerging creator	Learn industry concepts and take the next correct step	Plain language education, guarded AI help, guided onboarding

5 Scope and release strategy

5.1 Minimum viable product

- Responsive landing page, authentication entry points, Free and Pro positioning, and legal links.

- Account registration, sign in, email verification, password reset, consent capture, and secure session management.
- Goal based onboarding covering role, goals, profile, genres, royalty needs, and release needs.
- Professional creator profile with identity, biography, location, skills, genres, credits, links, media, availability, and visibility controls.
- Creator discovery with search, filters, matching explanation, profile view, connection requests, and blocking or reporting.
- Collaboration workspace with requests, briefs, statuses, participants, milestones, messages, files, and ownership split capture.
- Curated opportunities directory with filters, saved items, application links, deadlines, verification state, and reporting.
- Release planner with project stage, date, checklist, task status, reminders, metadata readiness, and campaign plan.
- Royalty education, streaming estimate ranges, statement ingestion, normalized summaries, calculation history, and manual income records.
- AI assistant workspace with usage limits, safety boundaries, conversation history, citations or source context where appropriate, and clear Pro gates.
- Settings, subscription management, notifications, privacy controls, data export, and account deletion.

5.2 Post MVP candidates

- Direct distributor, streaming, social, publishing, or collecting society connections where APIs and user authorization permit.
- Team workspaces with granular permissions and multi artist portfolio management.
- Verified identity, verified credits, reputation signals, and dispute workflows.
- Native mobile applications, live audio review, advanced forecasting, and market benchmarking.
- Contract workflow, electronic signatures, payments, escrow, invoicing, tax documentation, and automated royalty claims, subject to legal and regulatory review.

5.3 Explicitly out of scope for initial launch

- Guaranteeing royalty amounts, identifying every missing payment, or presenting estimates as accounting statements.
- Providing legal representation, regulated financial advice, tax advice, or automated contract execution.
- Scraping protected platforms or collecting private data without authorization.
- Operating as a distributor, publisher, label, bank, collecting society, or rights management organization.

6 Information architecture

Area	Primary screens
Public	Landing, feature overview, pricing, trust and safety, help, terms, privacy
Access	Sign up, sign in, verification, password reset, session recovery
Onboarding	Role, goals, basic profile, genres, royalty setup, release setup, completion
Dashboard	Personalized overview, active goals, next actions, alerts, usage, profile completion

Area	Primary screens
Network	Discover, search results, creator profile, connections, collaboration requests, messages
Career	Opportunities, saved opportunities, applications, release projects, tasks
Money and rights	Royalty overview, calculator, statements, income sources, rights education, splits
AI team	Assistant directory, conversation workspace, history, usage, feedback and escalation
Account	Profile editor, notifications, billing, integrations, privacy, security, export and deletion

7 Core user journeys

7.1 Registration and goal based onboarding

1. Visitor selects Join the network or Sign in.
2. New user creates an account, accepts required terms, verifies identity or email, and starts onboarding.
3. User chooses a primary role and up to three initial goals.
4. All users complete a minimum professional profile.
5. The product routes the user to relevant setup: genres for discovery, royalty setup for income goals, release setup for release goals, then the dashboard.
6. Multiple goals remain active; the dashboard presents all relevant modules rather than forcing a single linear journey.

7.2 Discovery to collaboration

7. User searches or filters creators.
8. System ranks results using profile fit and displays an understandable match rationale.
9. User opens a profile, reviews credits and availability, then sends a connection or collaboration request.
10. Recipient accepts, declines, asks a question, blocks, or reports.
11. Accepted participants enter a collaboration workspace with brief, roles, milestones, messages, files, and proposed ownership splits.

7.3 Royalty understanding

12. User chooses calculator, statement upload, connected source, manual entry, or education.
13. Calculator returns an estimated range with assumptions rather than a guaranteed per stream amount.
14. Statement ingestion validates file type, scans for malicious content, extracts supported fields, normalizes data, and shows confidence or unresolved fields.
15. Dashboard groups income by source, work, platform, territory, period, currency, and royalty category.
16. User can correct mappings, export their data, and learn what additional rights or registrations may apply.

7.4 AI assistance

17. User selects an assistant or begins from a contextual prompt inside a workflow.
18. System discloses capabilities, limitations, plan usage, and relevant data permissions.
19. Assistant gathers context, produces an actionable response, and links recommendations to source data or user inputs.

20. High risk legal, financial, or rights questions trigger disclaimers and professional referral guidance.
21. User rates the answer, saves it to a project, continues the conversation, or reports a problem.

8 Functional requirements

8.1 Priority definition

P0 is required for MVP launch. P1 is required soon after launch or for a complete commercial experience. P2 is optional or exploratory.

ID	Requirement	Priority	Acceptance summary
AUTH 01	Register sign in verify email reset password and sign out	P0	Valid states, secure sessions, clear errors, and recovery work across supported devices
ONB 01	Save role goals profile genres and contextual setup	P0	Progress persists and routing supports multiple goals without loops
PRO 01	Create edit preview and control visibility of a creator profile	P0	Owner changes persist; public view respects privacy settings
DISC 01	Search and filter creators	P0	Name, role, genre, skills, and location filters return paginated relevant results
MATCH 01	Show match score or rationale	P1	Users can see factors; protected traits are excluded from ranking
CONN 01	Send accept decline cancel block and report connection requests	P0	Transitions are permission checked, idempotent, and audited
COLL 01	Create and manage collaboration briefs	P0	Brief supports roles, genre, description, budget visibility, dates, status, and participants
MSG 01	Exchange messages in accepted contexts	P0	Authorized users can send, receive, report, mute, and retain messages
OPP 01	Browse save and open verified opportunities	P0	Items show source, deadline, eligibility, region, cost, and verification state
REL 01	Create release project and task plan	P0	Project supports type, title, stage, target date, needs, tasks, reminders, and completion
ROY 01	Estimate master streaming revenue	P0	Output is a range with versioned assumptions, ownership share, currency, and disclaimer
ROY 02	Upload and process royalty statements	P0	Supported documents are securely stored, parsed, normalized, corrected, and deletable

ID	Requirement	Priority	Acceptance summary
ROY 03	Explain royalty categories and next actions	P0	Education distinguishes master, mechanical, performance, neighboring, sync, and contractual income
AI 01	Use specialized assistants within plan limits	P0	Entitlements, safety messages, history, feedback, and failure states are visible
BILL 01	View plan upgrade manage payment and cancel	P0	Entitlements update from verified billing events and cancellation terms are clear
NOTIF 01	Manage in app and email notifications	P1	Users control categories and receive time sensitive collaboration and release alerts
PRIV 01	Export data delete account and manage consent	P0	Requests are authenticated, tracked, and completed according to policy

8.2 Profile requirements

- Required: display name, unique username, primary role, country or region, short biography, and at least one genre or skill when relevant.
- Optional: city, pronouns, experience, availability, rates or budget preference, languages, credits, portfolio media, social links, streaming links, services, influences, and collaboration preferences.
- Visibility controls must apply at field or profile level where sensitive information is involved.
- Credits require source information and must support pending, verified, rejected, and disputed states in later phases.
- Profile completeness is calculated from transparent criteria and must not punish users for withholding optional sensitive data.

8.3 Collaboration state model

Object	States	Required behavior
Connection request	Pending, accepted, declined, cancelled, blocked	Only authorized actors can transition state; repeated requests are rate limited
Collaboration brief	Draft, open, matched, active, completed, cancelled	Owner controls publishing and participant access
Invitation	Pending, accepted, declined, expired	Expiration and notification behavior are configurable
Milestone	Not started, in progress, blocked, completed	Assignee, due date, notes, and activity history are retained
Split proposal	Draft, proposed, acknowledged, disputed	Acknowledgment is not represented as a legal signature unless a compliant signing system is added

9 AI assistant system

AI assistants are role based experiences over a shared governed platform. They may use user supplied profile, project, release, royalty, or collaboration context only when the user has permission to share that data with the assistant. Assistant names describe focus, not licensed professional status.

Assistant	Core purpose	Example outputs	Boundary
AI A and R	Evaluate creative positioning and release readiness	Structured feedback, reference questions, audience hypotheses	Does not guarantee commercial success or label interest
Artist Manager	Prioritize career actions and coordinate goals	Weekly plan, decision framework, opportunity checklist	Does not enter agreements or represent the user
Legal Information Assistant	Explain terms, rights concepts, and contract questions	Plain language clause explanation, issue checklist, lawyer questions	Not legal advice; cannot approve a contract
Content Strategist	Plan content aligned with artist identity and release stage	Content calendar, concepts, captions, channel adaptations	Must respect platform rules, rights, and user voice
Release Planner	Generate and maintain release plans	Timeline, tasks, dependencies, metadata checklist	Dates and requirements must be editable and source aware
Strategy Assistant	Translate goals and data into career strategy	Quarterly priorities, experiments, metrics	Predictions are probabilistic and must state assumptions
Collaboration Matcher	Recommend collaborators and explain fit	Ranked matches, compatibility rationale, outreach draft	Must not infer sensitive traits or manipulate ranking for payment without disclosure
Profile Manager	Improve profile completeness and positioning	Bio suggestions, missing-field prompts, portfolio organization	User approves every public change
Royalty Assistant	Explain calculations, statements, rights categories, and next steps	Statement summary, anomalies, missing-data questions	Not accounting, tax, legal, or guaranteed collections advice

9.1 AI platform requirements

- Use a server side model gateway; never expose model provider keys in the browser.
- Apply authentication, entitlement checks, rate limits, moderation, input validation, prompt injection defenses, and audit logging.
- Separate system instructions from user content and treat uploaded documents and external content as untrusted data.
- Maintain versioned prompts, model configuration, evaluation datasets, latency and cost monitoring, and rollback capability.
- Display uncertainty and distinguish user facts, extracted facts, estimates, and generated recommendations.
- For legal, financial, royalty, or contract topics, provide plain limitations and recommend qualified professional review when consequences may be material.
- Do not train on private user content by default. Any optional improvement program requires explicit, revocable consent.
- Support user feedback, harmful response reporting, conversation deletion, retention controls, and incident investigation.

10 Royalty intelligence

10.1 Supported royalty concepts

Category	Explanation	Typical parties or sources
Master recording	Income related to exploitation of a sound recording	Master owner, label, distributor, recording artist, producer by contract
Mechanical	Composition income associated with reproduction or distribution under applicable rules	Songwriters, publishers, mechanical rights organizations
Performance	Composition income from qualifying public performance and broadcast	Songwriters, publishers, performance rights organizations
Neighboring rights	Related rights income for qualifying uses of recordings and performances	Performers, master owners, collecting organizations
Synchronization	Fees for pairing music with visual media	Composition and master rights holders
Producer or featured artist share	Contractual participation in recording income	Producers, featured artists, engineers where agreed
Direct sales and licensing	Income from downloads, physical products, direct licenses, or user generated content systems	Rights holders and contracted participants

10.2 Streaming estimator requirements

- Accept platform, stream count, territory mix or selected market, reporting period, ownership percentage, distributor or label deduction when known, and display currency.
- Return low, midpoint, and high scenarios. Never claim a single universal fixed per stream rate.
- Store the rate source, effective date, version, territory assumptions, currency rate source, and calculation formula used.
- Separate gross platform estimate, contractual deductions, taxes if entered, and estimated user share.
- Explain what is excluded, including composition royalties unless separately modeled.
- Allow saving, comparing, exporting, and deleting calculations.

10.3 Statement ingestion requirements

- Support CSV first; add XLSX and PDF only when extraction quality and security controls meet release thresholds.
- Scan uploads, restrict file types and sizes, encrypt at rest and in transit, isolate processing, and expire temporary artifacts.
- Map source columns to a canonical schema: source, statement period, work, recording identifier, territory, platform, usage type, units, gross amount, deductions, net amount, currency, and payee.
- Show extracted values and confidence, require confirmation for uncertain mappings, and preserve the original statement for traceability under the retention policy.
- Detect duplicates before import and support reversal or deletion without corrupting totals.
- Anomaly or missing-income messages must be phrased as possible issues requiring confirmation, not factual claims of underpayment.

11 Membership and monetization

Final pricing and exact limits require commercial approval and cost modeling. The entitlement structure below defines behavior without inventing prices.

Capability	Free	Pro
Professional profile	Core profile and public sharing	Enhanced portfolio, deeper analytics, and priority presentation where disclosed
Discovery	Search and limited connection activity	Advanced filters, higher limits, and enhanced matching
Collaborations	Core requests and limited active projects	More active projects, files, templates, and team features
Opportunities	Browse and save	Advanced recommendations, alerts, and tracking
Release planner	One basic active plan or limited usage	Multiple plans, AI generation, deeper templates, and reminders
Royalty calculator	Limited estimates and education	Saved scenarios, advanced assumptions, history, and exports
Statements	Limited preview or trial import	Higher import limits, normalization, analytics, and anomaly review
AI assistants	Limited messages or guided trials	Expanded usage across all assistants subject to fair use
Support	Standard self service	Priority support target

11.1 Revenue model

- Monthly and annual Pro subscriptions for individual creators.
- Team or manager plans after permissions and portfolio workflows are proven.
- Institutional partnerships with schools, accelerators, associations, and creator programs.
- Verified opportunity promotion or marketplace fees only when labeling, ranking, eligibility, and conflicts are transparent.
- Future referral or transaction revenue only with explicit consent and no hidden reduction of creator income.

11.2 Billing requirements

- Use a supported payment provider and server verified webhooks as the source of entitlement truth.
- Show price, currency, taxes if applicable, renewal date, trial rules, cancellation effect, refund policy, and feature limits before purchase.
- Support failed payment recovery, grace period policy, invoices or receipts, plan change, cancellation, and entitlement reconciliation.
- Do not permanently delete user projects immediately after downgrade; apply a communicated read only or limit policy.

12 Production architecture

12.1 Frontend

- React with TypeScript and a modern build framework. The team should choose the specific framework after evaluating routing, rendering, hosting, authentication, and SEO needs.
- Reusable design system for navigation, cards, forms, modal dialogs, empty states, loading states, plan gates, tables, charts, and responsive layouts.
- Route guards for authentication and onboarding completion; server state managed separately from local UI state.
- Accessible semantic HTML, keyboard navigation, visible focus, reduced motion support, form labels, error summaries, and screen reader announcements.
- No production financial, authentication, or entitlement state in localStorage. Browser storage may hold non sensitive preferences only.

12.2 Backend service boundaries

Service or module	Responsibility
Identity and access	Accounts, verification, sessions, password recovery, roles, permissions, consent
Profiles and network	Creator profiles, credits, media references, discovery index, connections, blocks, reports
Collaboration	Briefs, invitations, participants, milestones, splits, files, activity
Messaging and notifications	Threads, messages, delivery state, moderation signals, preferences, email or push
Opportunities	Opportunity records, verification, eligibility, saving, reporting, application tracking
Release planning	Release projects, tasks, templates, reminders, metadata readiness
Royalty	Calculations, rate versions, documents, extraction, normalized transactions, summaries, exports
AI orchestration	Model gateway, context authorization, prompt versions, tools, safety, usage, evaluations
Billing and entitlements	Plans, subscriptions, invoices, provider events, limits, usage counters
Administration and trust	Moderation queue, audit logs, content review, disputes, support tooling

12.3 API expectations

- Versioned HTTPS APIs with consistent errors, pagination, idempotency for mutation retries, authorization at every resource, and request validation.
- OpenAPI specification or equivalent contract generated and reviewed before frontend integration.
- Stable identifiers, UTC timestamps, explicit currencies, decimal-safe money representation, and no floating point storage for financial amounts.

- Webhooks or asynchronous jobs for document processing, billing, integrations, email, and long running AI tasks.
- Frontend must render loading, empty, partial, unauthorized, rate limited, validation, processing, and retry states.

13 Data and integration requirements

13.1 Core entities

Entity	Selected fields
User	id, email, authentication state, status, locale, timezone, consent versions, created at
Creator profile	user id, username, display name, role, bio, location, genres, skills, availability, visibility
Credit	profile id, work, role, date, identifiers, evidence, verification state
Goal	user id, type, priority, state, selected at
Connection	requester, recipient, state, timestamps
Collaboration	owner, brief, role needed, genre, budget, dates, status, participants
Opportunity	source, title, type, region, eligibility, deadline, cost, verification state, URL
Release project	owner, title, type, stage, target date, support needs, task progress
Royalty calculation	owner, inputs, rate version, scenarios, currency, timestamp
Royalty statement	owner, source, period, file reference, processing state, schema version
Royalty transaction	statement, recording, work, platform, territory, usage, units, gross, deductions, net, currency
AI conversation	owner, assistant type, project context, messages, model and prompt versions, safety state, usage
Subscription	user, provider reference, plan, state, renewal, entitlements

13.2 Third party integration policy

Potential services include Spotify, Apple Music, Boomplay, Audiomack, YouTube, distributors, social networks, payment providers, email providers, object storage, analytics, and model providers. Every integration requires documented authorization method, permitted data, rate limits, retention rules, user disconnect behavior, deletion behavior, error handling, and compliance with the provider's current terms. A product requirement must not assume an API provides royalty payment data merely because it provides public stream or catalog data.

14 Security privacy legal and trust

Control area	Minimum requirement
Authentication	Secure session cookies or equivalent, strong password policy, email verification, rate limiting, brute force protection, optional MFA roadmap
Authorization	Object level permission checks, least privilege, admin separation, tenant boundaries for teams
Encryption	TLS in transit; encryption at rest for databases, object storage, secrets, and backups
Uploads	Allowlist, size limits, malware scanning, isolated parsing, signed URLs, retention and deletion
Financial data	Decimal-safe storage, currency and source metadata, audit trail, restricted employee access
Privacy	Purpose limitation, data minimization, consent, retention schedule, export, correction, deletion, processor inventory
Trust and safety	Block, report, moderation queue, impersonation handling, harassment policy, opportunity fraud review
AI safety	Moderation, prompt injection defense, sensitive data controls, output reporting, high risk escalation
Operations	Centralized logs, alerts, backup restore tests, incident response, dependency scanning, secret rotation

14.1 Required product disclosures

- Royalty estimates are educational ranges and not guaranteed payments.
- The Legal Information Assistant provides general information and is not a lawyer or substitute for legal advice.
- AI recommendations may be incomplete or wrong and require user judgment.
- Connection, verification, match, and opportunity labels must have documented meanings.
- Users must understand what data is public, shared with collaborators, processed by AI, or transferred to integration providers.

15 Analytics and success measures

15.1 North star

Weekly active creators who complete at least one meaningful career action: a qualified connection or collaboration action, opportunity action, release task, royalty analysis action, or saved AI assisted action.

15.2 Product metrics

Area	Metrics
Acquisition	Visitor to registration conversion, channel, cost per acquired user

Area	Metrics
Activation	Verification rate, onboarding completion, profile completion, first meaningful action within 24 hours
Network	Search to profile view, request rate, acceptance rate, collaboration creation, report rate
Release	Projects created, plan completion, task completion, on time release intent
Royalty	Calculations completed, statements successfully parsed, correction rate, repeat usage, export rate
AI	Active users, completion, save or apply rate, user rating, escalation rate, safety incidents, cost per useful action
Revenue	Free to Pro conversion, trial conversion, monthly recurring revenue, churn, failed payment recovery
Quality	Crash free sessions, API error rate, latency, accessibility defects, support contacts, deletion completion

Analytics must use a documented event taxonomy, avoid collecting message or document contents by default, respect consent, and exclude sensitive values from logs and URLs.

16 Nonfunctional requirements

Category	MVP target
Availability	Define and monitor service level objectives before beta; graceful degradation for noncritical AI and integration features
Performance	Fast perceived loading on common mobile networks; paginate large datasets; background long running tasks
Accessibility	WCAG 2.2 AA target for core journeys, with automated and manual testing
Responsiveness	Support current major mobile, tablet, and desktop browsers; define minimum browser matrix
Localization	Internationalization ready strings, locale aware dates and numbers, explicit currency, timezone support
Scalability	Stateless application services where practical, queues for heavy work, indexed discovery, storage lifecycle controls
Observability	Structured logs, traces, metrics, product events, correlation IDs, alerting and dashboards
Recovery	Automated backups, documented recovery objectives, restore tests, data reconciliation procedures
Maintainability	Typed contracts, tests, linting, code review, feature flags, migration strategy, documented ownership

17 Delivery plan and acceptance

17.1 Recommended phases

Phase	Outcome	Primary deliverables
0 Alignment	Approved product and technical baseline	PRD, architecture decision records, data classification, API plan, design system inventory
1 Foundation	Secure account and application shell	React foundation, design system, authentication, onboarding, profile, CI CD, observability
2 Network	Creators can discover and connect	Search, profiles, connections, collaboration briefs, messaging baseline, safety controls
3 Career workflow	Users manage opportunities and releases	Opportunity directory, saved items, release planner, tasks, reminders
4 Money and rights	Users estimate and organize income	Royalty education, calculator, rate governance, CSV ingestion, normalization, history
5 AI and Pro	Governed intelligence and monetization	AI gateway, assistants, entitlements, billing, usage, evaluations, support readiness
6 Beta and launch	Measured production release	Security review, accessibility audit, load test, migration plan, legal review, beta feedback

17.2 Definition of done

- Requirement has approved design, copy, loading, empty, error, unauthorized, and responsive states.
- Frontend and backend use an agreed typed API contract with automated integration tests.
- Authorization, validation, privacy, analytics, and audit requirements are implemented.
- Unit, integration, end to end, accessibility, and relevant security tests pass.
- Monitoring, support documentation, feature flag or rollback plan, and data migration are ready.
- Product owner accepts the behavior against documented acceptance criteria.

17.3 MVP release acceptance

- A new user can register, verify, complete goal based onboarding, and reach a personalized dashboard without dead ends or routing loops.
- A creator can publish a profile, discover another creator, send a request, and manage the resulting state.
- A user can create a release project and complete tasks with persisted progress.
- A user can calculate an explicitly labeled royalty estimate and save the versioned assumptions.
- A supported CSV statement can be securely processed, reviewed, corrected, summarized, exported, and deleted.
- A Free user can understand limits and upgrade; verified payment events correctly update Pro entitlements.
- AI assistant outputs show relevant limitations, honor usage limits, retain approved history, and pass launch evaluations.
- Core journeys pass accessibility, security, privacy, browser, and responsive acceptance tests.

18 Risks dependencies and open decisions

18.1 Principal risks

Risk	Impact	Mitigation
Royalty estimates are treated as guaranteed income	Loss of trust or legal exposure	Ranges, assumptions, versioning, disclaimers, review by royalty specialists
Third party data access is less complete than expected	Tracking promise cannot be met	Validate APIs before commitments; support statements and manual records
AI provides unsafe legal or financial guidance	User harm and liability	Scope boundaries, evaluation, escalation, moderation, qualified professional referrals
Fake profiles or fraudulent opportunities	Safety and reputation damage	Verification states, reporting, review queue, rate limits, evidence and enforcement
Free plan is too limited	Weak activation and network effects	Protect meaningful free journeys; test limits using retention data
AI and document processing costs exceed revenue	Poor unit economics	Usage quotas, asynchronous processing, model routing, caching, cost dashboards
Prototype assumptions enter production	Security and data integrity failures	Replace localStorage and demo data; production readiness checklist and architecture review

18.2 Dependencies

- Commercial approval of plan limits, pricing, supported currencies, and launch markets.
- Legal review of terms, privacy, AI disclosures, opportunity policy, and royalty education.
- Technical validation of data providers, royalty statement formats, storage, OCR or extraction, and payment provider.
- Design completion for all core states and a reusable accessible component system.
- Content expertise for royalty education, release templates, opportunity verification, and AI evaluations.
- Operational ownership for moderation, support, incidents, billing disputes, and data rights requests.

18.3 Decisions required before production build

Decision	Owner	Decision point
Launch countries, languages, currencies, and legal entities	Executive and legal	Before billing and privacy implementation
Production React framework and hosting model	Technical lead	Before frontend foundation
Authentication and payment providers	Technical and commercial	Before foundation integration
Exact Free and Pro entitlements and prices	Product and commercial	Before billing UX and limits
Supported royalty sources and initial file schemas	Product, data, royalty specialist	Before royalty ingestion

Decision	Owner	Decision point
AI model providers, retention, and human escalation policy	AI, security, legal	Before AI beta
Verification and opportunity moderation operating model	Trust and operations	Before network beta

19 Appendix

19.1 Current prototype inventory

Screen	Prototype behavior	Production replacement
Landing	Marketing sections and calls to action	Content managed, measured, accessible public experience
Sign up and sign in	Frontend forms and page routing	Identity provider or secure authentication service
Onboarding	Role and goal selections stored locally	Authenticated profile and onboarding APIs
Dashboard	Personalization from localStorage	Server state, entitlements, real notifications and analytics
Royalty calculator	Illustrative static rates and currency values	Governed rate service, sources, versioning, exchange rate provider
Statement upload	Local file metadata preview	Secure upload, scanning, parsing, normalization, correction and deletion
Discover	Static creator data and local connection requests	Search index, real profiles, permissions, trust and safety
AI assistants	Locked cards and modal preview	Governed model gateway, context, tools, history, limits and safety

19.2 Suggested API resource groups

/auth, /users, /profiles, /credits, /goals, /connections, /collaborations, /messages, /opportunities, /release-projects, /royalty-calculations, /royalty-statements, /royalty-transactions, /ai-conversations, /subscriptions, /entitlements, /notifications, /reports, and /admin. Final paths and protocols remain an engineering decision; behavior and permission contracts are the requirement.

19.3 Glossary

Term	Meaning in SoundBridge
Creator	Any product user participating professionally in music creation or its supporting ecosystem
PRO or CMO	A performance rights organization or collective management organization, depending on territory

Term	Meaning in SoundBridge
Master	The sound recording and associated ownership or exploitation rights
Composition	The underlying song, including melody and lyrics
Royalty statement	A report describing uses, revenue, deductions, and amounts payable from a source
Entitlement	A server controlled permission or limit associated with a membership plan
Meaningful action	A completed user action tied to networking, collaboration, opportunities, release work, royalties, or applied AI guidance